ART

Palace of Fine Arts

The soon-to-open **Jaipur Art Centre** could bring its setting, the City Palace, back into the cultural life of the city

A new landmark hopes to put Jaipur at the forefront of the global contemporary art discourse with the opening of the City Palace in November. The Jaipur Centre for Art (JCA) is the culmination of the vision of former royal Sawai Padmanabh Singh of Jaipur and contemporary art specialist Noelle Kadar (*in picture*). The 2,600 sq. ft public space will hold thoughtfully curated exhibitions of Indian and international artists as well as a unique artist residency programme.

"JCA stands as a testament to our commitment to the city's artistic heritage and creative potential. I hope to contribute to bridging the history of my lineage and the evolving contemporary world and be remembered as a responsible custodian of Jaipur's heritage," says Singh. With decades of experience in contemporary art, co-founder Kadar says, "Our mission is to open the doors of Jaipur to the world, inviting galleries, artists and art enthusiasts from across the globe to experience contemporary art practices through the unique perspective of this vibrant city."

The idea emerged from the founders' desire to create a space where Jaipur's rich artistic heritage could seamlessly interact with the evolving world of contemporary art. The opening exhibition, a group show curated by Peter Nagy, will feature a diverse range, including painting, sculpture and photography.

At the heart of the Centre's vision is its artist residency programme, which will allow artists to live and work within the historic City Palace complex. "By facilitating interactions between contemporary artists and Jaipur's heritage, we aim to create a space where innovative ideas can thrive. The residency is more than just about creating art—it's about creating a dialogue between the past and the present, local and global, in a way that truly reflects the spirit of JCA," says Kadar.

In the coming months, JCA will host artist talks, guided tours and intimate gatherings where art enthusiasts can engage directly with both the works and their creators. For collectors and patrons, there will be a range of exclusive events, including private viewings, interactive workshops and curated walks through the City Palace. Special collaborations with local artisans are also planned, with guests invited to explore the intersection of contemporary art and Jaipur's rich craft traditions. "The goal is to create a vibrant cultural calendar that deepens the connection between the audience, the art and Jaipur's unique heritage," concludes Kadar. ■

–Neha Kirpal



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